

Saturday, 29 August 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

BIRMINGHAM

Light rain

18° 16°

MANCHESTER

Heavy drizzle

18° 16°

GLASGOW

Light drizzle

22° 14°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

1 Nearly a million young people in the UK are currently not in education, employment, or training.
New figures show that one in eight young people are classed as 'Neet' ahead of a major government review. It highlights a significant challenge for the country's youth.
SOCIAL · UK

2 Almost 500 salmonella cases linked to imported eggs have been reported across the UK.
Health authorities are investigating multiple clusters of the illness. Consumers are being urged to be vigilant about the source of their eggs.
HEALTH · UK

3 Taxpayers are footing a £6 million bill to clean up an illegal waste site in Oxfordshire.
The huge cost highlights the ongoing problem of illegal dumping and the financial burden it places on the public purse. Authorities are working to clear the site.
ENVIRONMENT · UK

4 Flights at Luton Airport were disrupted yesterday after a lightning strike.
While flights have now resumed, the incident caused a number of cancellations and diversions for travellers. Passengers faced delays and altered plans.
TRAVEL · UK

5 A 65-year-old teacher has been found guilty of indecent assaults against two pupils.
Sally-Anne Bowen was convicted at Harrow Crown Court on seven counts. The case has sent shockwaves through the educational community.
CRIME · UK

What's coming up

- 1 Creamfields festival is gearing up for its 20th anniversary celebration this weekend.**
The annual four-day dance music event is taking place in Daresbury, Cheshire. Expect huge crowds and top DJs marking two decades of the festival.
ON AIR – Are you heading to Creamfields this weekend, or have you been before? What's your favourite festival memory?
MUSIC · THIS WEEKEND
- 2 Top Gear is set to return to our screens, four years after its last series.**
The BBC has confirmed the motoring show will be back, after being 'rested' following Andrew Flintoff's crash in 2022. More details on presenters are expected soon.
ON AIR – Who would you love to see presenting the new series of Top Gear? Any dream teams?
TV · COMING SOON
- 3 A 1979 interview with the late Dolly Parton has resurfaced, showing her reflecting on her early life.**
The legendary singer spoke candidly about her childhood poverty in rural Tennessee. She shared how determination helped her rise to international stardom.
ON AIR – What's your favourite Dolly Parton song, and why does it resonate with you?
MUSIC · ARCHIVE
- 4 Dolly Parton's unique style is being celebrated as she's remembered as a true fashion icon.**
Her signature looks, from big hair to rhinestones, were as iconic as her music. She created a visual identity that helped her conquer the world.
ON AIR – Dolly Parton was instantly recognisable. Who else in music has such an iconic, unforgettable style?
FASHION · ARCHIVE
- 5 The 'dotty' world of Japanese artist Yayoi Kusama is being revisited in pictures.**
Kusama, who recently passed away, was renowned for creating extraordinary immersive worlds. Her colourful creations delighted millions of visitors worldwide.
ON AIR – Have you ever experienced one of Yayoi Kusama's installations? What was it like?
ART · ARCHIVE

On the schedule

- 1 **England are fighting back on day one of the second Test against Pakistan at Lord's.**
 Jamie Smith hit 61 and Jordan Cox added 55 to help the hosts recover from a tricky start. They closed on 248-9 after being 77-4 at one point.
ON AIR – What's your prediction for the rest of this Test match? Can England turn it around?
 CRICKET · UK

- 2 **British heavyweight Moses Itauma is fighting for the vacant IBF world title this Saturday.**
 If he wins, Itauma, aged 21, will become the youngest heavyweight champion since Mike Tyson. He faces Filip Hrgovic in a highly anticipated bout.
ON AIR – Do you think Moses Itauma has what it takes to become the youngest heavyweight champion since Mike Tyson?
 BOXING · THIS WEEKEND

- 3 **Defending champion Tommy Fleetwood is in contention at the Tour Championship in Atlanta.**
 Fleetwood shot a four-under 66 to put himself firmly in the mix. He's looking to retain his title at East Lake.
ON AIR – Who are you backing to win the Tour Championship this weekend? Will Fleetwood defend his title?
 GOLF · INTERNATIONAL

- 4 **Chelsea have agreed a £7.5 million fee to sign Aston Villa goalkeeper Emiliano Martinez.**
 The move sees the Argentine World Cup winner switch clubs in a significant transfer deal. It's a big signing for the Blues.
ON AIR – Is Emiliano Martinez the right signing for Chelsea? What will he bring to the team?
 FOOTBALL · UK

- 5 **Rangers manager Derek McInnes has taken full responsibility for their 'embarrassing' European exit.**
 Rangers were knocked out of the Conference League by Jablonec, a result McInnes described as 'mortifying'. It's a tough pill for fans to swallow.
ON AIR – How big a blow is this European exit for Rangers and their season ambitions?
 FOOTBALL · UK

Quick hits

- 1 Scientists have found that looking at photos of cute animals can actually boost your concentration.**
Apparently, a quick scroll through some adorable kittens or puppies before a task can make you more focused and meticulous. A purr-fect excuse for a quick break, wouldn't you say?
- 2 The delightful tradition of 'porch presents' is making a charming comeback in neighbourhoods across the UK.**
It involves leaving small, unexpected gifts or baked goods on a neighbour's doorstep, just to spread a bit of joy. A lovely way to connect with your community!
- 3 New research suggests that spending time near 'natural water features' like rivers or fountains can significantly improve your mood.**
The gentle sounds and calming visual of moving water are thought to reduce stress and increase feelings of tranquility. Time for a riverside stroll, perhaps?
- 4 The simple act of 'waving hello' to strangers you pass by is being hailed as a small but mighty mood booster.**
Studies indicate that these brief, positive interactions can create a sense of belonging and even increase overall happiness. Give it a go!
- 5 A growing number of people are discovering the meditative benefits of 'micro-gardening' in tiny spaces.**
Even a windowsill herb garden or a few small potted plants can provide a calming connection to nature and a sense of accomplishment. Green fingers, big or small!
- 6 Experts are suggesting that incorporating 'surprise elements' into your daily routine can help keep life feeling fresh and exciting.**
This could be anything from trying a new route to work to experimenting with a different recipe for dinner. A little spontaneity goes a long way!
- 7 There's a lovely trend for 'community notice boards' that go beyond just adverts, sharing local stories and positive news.**
These boards are becoming hubs for local pride, celebrating neighbourly acts and quirky local happenings. A real paper-based social network!

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 60% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when we're trying to quickly judge if a new brand of cereal will be good, even if we know it's not strictly scientific?

ANSWER: SMELLING THE BOX VERY INTENTLY, AS IF THAT WILL REVEAL FLAVOUR NUANCES.

Q Our survey said that over 55% of us admit to having a particular 'odd habit' they absolutely have to do before settling down to enjoy a lovely, warm bath, especially when it's a new bath bomb.

ANSWER: POKING THE BATH BOMB WITH A FINGER TO TEST ITS FIZZINESS POTENTIAL BEFORE IT HITS THE WATER.

TALK TOPIC

- You know how sometimes you spot someone doing something really clever with an everyday object, making it serve a completely different purpose?

What's the most ingenious 'hack' or alternative use for an everyday item you've ever seen or even come up with yourself?

- We all have those 'comfort sounds' that instantly make us feel relaxed or happy, like the sound of rain on a window or a kettle boiling.

What's your ultimate comfort sound, the one that can always soothe or cheer you up, no matter what?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Weather.** It is technically possible for it to rain diamonds on giant planets like Jupiter and Saturn, where atmospheric conditions can compress carbon into precious stones.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Butterflies are believed to hibernate for months by completely encasing themselves in a self-spun, transparent silk cocoon, emerging only when flowers bloom.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£4.2 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£4.2 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The shortest war in history was between Britain and Zanzibar on August 27, 1896, lasting only 38 minutes.
- A group of flamingos is called a 'flamboyance'.
- Honey never spoils; archaeologists have found pots of honey in ancient Egyptian tombs that are over 3,000 years old and still edible.
- The 'richest' soil on Earth is called 'Chernozem', found in places like the Ukrainian steppes, known for its deep black colour and high fertility.
- The human nose can remember 50,000 different scents.
- The longest recorded flight of a chicken is 13 seconds.
- The 'Great Pyramid of Giza' was originally covered in highly polished white limestone, making it shine brightly in the sun.
- A 'jiffy' is an actual unit of time, specifically 1/100th of a second.

On this day

Day 241 of the year, 124 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Adelphus of Metz; Christian feast day: Beheading of St. John the Baptist; Christian feast day: Bronislava of Poland; Christian feast day: Eadwold of Cerne. Star sign Virgo, birthstone Peridot.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1987 — Tony Kane, Northern Irish footballer
- 1971 — Carla Gugino, American actress
- 1927 — Jimmy C. Newman, American singer-songwriter and guitarist (died 2014)
- 1945 — Chris Copping, English singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1926 — Betty Lynn, American actress (died 2021)
- 1976 — Stephen Carr, Irish footballer
- 1942 — Sterling Morrison, American singer and guitarist (died 1995)
- 1951 — Geoff Whitehorn, English singer-songwriter and guitarist

THE DAY TODAY

- 1960 — Air France Flight 343 crashes on approach to Yoff Airport in Senegal, killing all 63 aboard.
- 1970 — Chicano Moratorium against the Vietnam War, East Los Angeles, California. Police riot kills three people, including journalist Rubén Salazar.
- 1982 — Meitnerium, a synthetic chemical element with the atomic number 109, is first synthesized at the Gesellschaft für Schwerionenforschung in Darmstadt, Germany.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1952 — American experimental composer John Cage's 4'33" premieres at Maverick Concert Hall, played by American pianist David Tudor.
- 2005 — Hurricane Katrina devastates much of the U.S. Gulf Coast from Louisiana to the Florida Panhandle, killing up to 1,392 people and causing \$125 billion in damage.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1949 — Soviet atomic bomb project: The Soviet Union tests its first atomic bomb, known as First Lightning or Joe 1, at Semipalatinsk, Kazakhstan.

1998 — Eighty people are killed when Cubana de Aviación Flight 389 crashes during a rejected takeoff from the Old Mariscal Sucre International Airport in Quito, Ecuador.

- 1960 — Air France Flight 343 crashes on approach to Yoff Airport in Senegal, killing all 63 aboard.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 242 of the year, 123 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Alexander of Constantinople (Eastern Orthodoxy); Christian feast day: Blessed Alfredo Ildefonso Schuster; Christian feast day: Blessed Eustáquio van Lieshout; Christian feast day: Blessed Stephen Nehmé (Maronite Church / Catholic Church). Star sign Virgo, birthstone Peridot.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1943 — David Maslanka, American composer and academic (died 2017)
- 1977 — Michael Gladis, American actor
- 1985 — Steven Smith, Scottish footballer
- 1946 — Peggy Lipton, American model and actress (died 2019)
- 1954 — David Paymer, American actor and director
- 1956 — Frank Conniff, American actor, producer, and screenwriter
- 1986 — Theo Hutchcraft, English singer-songwriter
- 1963 — Dave Brockie, Canadian-American singer-songwriter and bass player (died 2014)

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1992 — The 11-day Ruby Ridge standoff ends with Randy Weaver surrendering to federal authorities.
- 1991 — Dissolution of the Soviet Union: Azerbaijan declares independence from Soviet Union.
- 1983 — Aeroflot Flight 5463 crashes into Dolan Mountain while approaching Almaty International Airport in present-day Kazakhstan, killing all 90 people on board.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1936 — The RMS Queen Mary wins the Blue Riband by setting the fastest transatlantic crossing.
- 1962 — Japan conducts a test of the NAMC YS-11, its first aircraft since World War II and its only successful commercial aircraft from before or after the war.

10 — FORWARD PLANNING • FILM

Coming to cinemas

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
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FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
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FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
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FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)
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OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
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FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)
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11 — FORWARD PLANNING • SPORT

On the sporting calendar